

THE POLITICS OF FORMATION

Chule “KK” Papiyana and the Making of a Generation

By Zola Pinda

A political commissar who sharpened minds, disciplined action, and insisted that principle could not be sacrificed to ambition — his life raises the question South Africa can no longer avoid: what kind of leadership does this moment demand?

There are figures in the history of a people who do not merely pass through institutions; they leave behind a method, a discipline, a moral temperature. They become, in ways not always immediately visible, part of the architecture of political memory itself. Their greatness is not always announced in the loud idiom of office, nor sealed by the ceremonial grammar of state. Often, it resides in the harder and less glamorous labour of shaping minds, steadying movements, and insisting that politics must be equal to history.

Chule “KK” Papiyana belonged to that order of political being.

He was my friend, my mentor, and my comrade. That is not a sentimental confession. It is a political fact. For it was through the intimacy of shared struggle — in residence rooms at Founders Hall, on long roads between campuses, in strategy sessions conducted under conditions of surveillance, and in the unrecorded hours between public events — that one truly learned the measure of the man. And what one learned was that KK's contribution to our generation was not peripheral. It was structural.

To write about him now is not simply to offer tribute to a departed comrade. It is to recover, with seriousness and fidelity, a tradition of political formation that helped shape a critical generation of black students in the last years of apartheid and the dangerous dawn of democracy. It is also to resist the casual erasures of our time, in which those who built the moral and intellectual scaffolding of the struggle are too easily eclipsed by those who later inherited its visible rewards.

KK was not merely a student activist in the narrow, episodic sense in which that term is often used. He was a political educator, an organiser of uncommon steadiness, and a strategist whose maturity was visible long before maturity became fashionable in public life. In an era marked by confrontation, repression, surveillance and institutional hostility, he carried into every room a seriousness of purpose that elevated debate and disciplined action. He understood that the student movement was not a theatre for youthful performance. It was a school of politics, a forge of ideas, and a preparatory ground for democratic responsibility.

That is how I remember him. That is how many of us must insist he be remembered.

The Epoch and the Generation

To understand KK's stature, one must first understand the epoch that produced him.

The late 1980s and early 1990s in South Africa were not merely years of protest. They were years of intense conceptual debate, of ideological ferment, of strategic argument conducted

under conditions of state repression and institutional uncertainty. The apartheid state was weakening, but it had not yet conceded. The liberation movements were approaching legality, but the future remained deeply uncertain. On campuses, in townships, in community halls and in exile missions, the question was not only whether apartheid would end, but what would replace it, and who would be equipped to build what came after.

This was the political atmosphere in which KK came of age.

The student movement of that period cannot be told honestly without locating it in the broader history of black student organisation in South Africa. From the South African Students' Organisation (SASO), born in 1968 under the leadership of Steve Biko, through the Azanian Students' Organisation (AZASO) and its transformation into the South African National Students' Congress (SANSCO) in 1986, black student politics had evolved from a Black Consciousness orientation toward a Congress movement tradition rooted in the Freedom Charter. This was not a superficial relabelling. It represented a substantive ideological realignment in which the theoretical premises of Black Consciousness were interrogated, debated, and, in the judgement of a majority of black student activists, found insufficient as a framework for the kind of non-racial, mass democratic politics that the historical moment demanded. SANSCO became an integral component of the broad mass democratic movement, aligned with the African National Congress and the United Democratic Front. Its leadership included figures such as Joe Phaahla, Reveal Nkondo, and others who understood that the student movement was not a peripheral phenomenon but a vital front in the national liberation struggle.

KK entered this tradition and helped define it. He belonged to a generation that had inherited the political consciousness of Soweto, the organisational lessons of the UDF, the theoretical frameworks of Marxist and nationalist debate, and the moral authority of those who had been expelled, detained, banned or killed for the crime of thinking while black. That generation did not have the luxury of superficial engagement. The stakes were too high, the surveillance too pervasive, and the consequences of political error too severe.

What distinguished KK within that generation was not volume. It was not bravado. It was an unmistakable gravitas — a quality of political seriousness that commanded attention without demanding it.

The University as Battlefield

Rhodes University during the transitional era was a complex, contradictory space. Set against the rolling hills of the Eastern Cape, it remained an elite enclave of traditional liberal academia, even as the surrounding townships of Joza and Fingo bore the marks of uprising and state repression. The institution carried the name of Cecil John Rhodes, a fact that itself embodied the unresolved contradiction between the university's professed liberal values and the colonial political economy from which it had been born.

For black students entering this environment, the institution presented a dual challenge: one had to master the rigorous academic curriculum while simultaneously confronting the subtle and overt racism embedded in the university's institutional culture. The campus, with its stone

facades, its manicured quadrangles, and its cultivated rituals of residence life, projected the composure of an old liberal establishment. But beneath that composure lay a restless and unequal order. Black students encountered not only the academic demands of a historically white institution but the social architecture of exclusion: the coded assumptions of certain lecturers, the racialised patterns of residence allocation, the silent curricula that treated European intellectual traditions as universal while rendering African thought peripheral, and the institutional instinct to manage racial tension through procedural silence rather than structural change.

The Black Students Movement (BSM) at Rhodes was the campus-level formation through which SANSCO operated. It was within the BSM that the political consciousness of black students was organised, sharpened, and connected to the national struggle. The BSM was not a society. It was a political project — and it carried the weight of that responsibility.

No historically honest account of that period can pretend that campus politics existed in isolation from the wider crisis of the country. The university was not detached from apartheid South Africa; it was one of its contested sites. Student residences, lecture halls, SRC offices, dining halls and informal caucus rooms became extensions of the national struggle. Questions of access, curriculum, dignity, race, power, worker solidarity, police repression and democratic participation were not abstract. They were immediate, lived, and often explosive. The SANSCO affiliate at Rhodes, like its counterparts at Wits and UWC, was proscribed under the apartheid state's regulations in December 1988, and there were police raids on the offices of SANSCO and the SRC. These were not abstract violations of civil liberties. They were assaults on the political infrastructure of organised black student thought.

It was in that crucible that KK emerged as one of the defining political minds of his cohort.

At Rhodes, and particularly within the political life that moved through Founders Hall and beyond it, one encountered many kinds of student leaders. There were the rhetoricians, always ready with slogans and indignation. There were the tacticians, alert to the mechanics of meetings and elections. There were also those who mistook agitation for analysis — who could mobilise a crowd but could not sustain an argument. KK was different. He was intellectually grounded without being aloof, ideologically clear without being doctrinaire, and politically disciplined without becoming sterile.

He listened carefully. He spoke with precision. He did not waste language. When he intervened in debate, he did so to clarify, not to impress. Where others sometimes responded to events at the surface level of outrage, KK insisted on asking the more demanding question: what underlying structure is at work here, and what form of organisation is required to confront it?

That was the difference between protest as reaction and politics as method.

The Making of Political Seriousness

One of the tragedies of post-apartheid public culture is that it has weakened our understanding of what political maturity actually looks like. Too often, we confuse noise with courage, ambition with capacity, and visibility with leadership. KK belonged to an older and

more exacting political ethic. For him, leadership was not performance. It was burden. It required reading, listening, discipline, memory, accountability, and the ability to connect immediate grievances to larger structural realities.

He understood, instinctively and intellectually, that oppressed people do not advance merely through anger. They advance when anger is organised into thought, when thought is translated into programme, and when programme is sustained by ethical commitment. This was not a formulation he had borrowed from a textbook. It was a conviction forged in the experience of organising under conditions where the cost of political error was not embarrassment but imprisonment, expulsion, or worse.

That is why his influence on fellow students ran deeper than the ordinary influence of campus office-bearers. He mentored politically. He educated through conversation, example, and critique. He challenged sloppy reasoning. He pushed younger comrades to read more seriously, argue more rigorously, and carry themselves with greater self-respect. He treated political development not as a side activity but as central to the work of liberation.

Long before formal political education modules were codified, KK ran informal reading groups dissecting the works of Frantz Fanon, Steve Biko, Paulo Freire, Karl Marx, and the foundational documents of the African National Congress and the South African Communist Party. These were not academic exercises. They were acts of political preparation. He understood that a movement that does not educate its members will eventually be outmanoeuvred by those who have mastered the instruments of power, even if those instruments are deployed in the service of injustice.

Many of us who came into those spaces full of urgency but not always full of method encountered in KK a different political standard. He was not interested in producing applause lines. He was interested in producing cadres who could think.

KK consistently drilled into us that black activists at Rhodes could not afford the luxury of academic mediocrity. "To fail your courses in the name of the revolution," he would remind us, "is to concede victory to those who claim we do not belong here. We must conquer the book and the street simultaneously."

This was not elitism. It was strategic clarity. He understood that the apartheid system sought to produce a particular kind of black graduate: one who had been technically trained but politically neutralised, who could be absorbed into the economy without threatening its structural foundations. Against that logic, KK insisted on a different model — the scholar-activist who mastered the institution's tools precisely in order to transform it.

He demanded familiarity with university statutes, budgets, and governance rules. He believed that one could not effectively challenge institutional racism without understanding how the institution actually operated — its committee structures, its financial flows, its decision-making hierarchies, and the language in which it defended its practices. This was a pedagogy of empowerment through institutional mastery, not merely resistance through protest.

“Politics is not a race toward personal visibility. It is an apprenticeship in service.”

The Wider Movement: The UDF and the Architecture of Democratic Transition

SANSCO did not operate in isolation. It was, as the historical record confirms, an active affiliate of the United Democratic Front and an integral component of the broad mass democratic movement. The UDF, launched nationally at Mitchell's Plain on 20 August 1983, was led by figures whose own political formation had been forged in the same crucible of resistance that shaped the student movement.

Among them was Comrade Popo Molefe, who served as the UDF's National Secretary following its launch. Molefe had been a founding member of the Azanian People's Organisation (AZAPO) before resigning in 1981 over the question of non-racialism, a dispute that placed him on the side of those who believed the struggle against apartheid required the active involvement of people of all races. He was elected co-secretary of the Transvaal UDF alongside Valli Moosa, and later served as National General-Secretary. In 1994, under the presidency of Nelson Rolihlahla Mandela, Molefe was appointed the first Premier of the North West Province, a position he held for two terms until April 2004.

Trevor Manuel served as the UDF's Regional Secretary in the Western Cape and as a member of its National Executive Committee from 1983. He was repeatedly detained without trial and placed under house arrest during the State of Emergency. In 1994, Mandela appointed him Minister of Trade and Industry, and in 1996, he became Minister of Finance — a position he held for thirteen years under three successive presidents, becoming one of the world's longest-serving finance ministers.

Cheryl Carolus was a founding member of the UDF in the Western Cape, serving as its General Secretary after the launch in August 1983. She was detained under emergency regulations, restricted from political activity, and barred from entering educational institutions. In 1990, she formed part of the ANC delegation that met the De Klerk government at Groote Schuur, producing the historic Groote Schuur Minute. She would later serve as Deputy Secretary General of the ANC under Mandela and as South Africa's High Commissioner to the United Kingdom.

These were not distant names. They were the senior figures of a movement whose political gravity pulled the student formations into its orbit. The UDF provided the strategic framework within which SANSCO operated. It connected campus struggles to community struggles, civic organisation to student politics, and the local to the national. KK understood this ecology. He did not treat the student movement as a self-contained world. He insisted that we understood our place within a wider democratic architecture.

That understanding had practical consequences. When the transition arrived and democratic governance began to take shape, the relationships forged within the UDF carried forward into the new dispensation. Comrade Popo Molefe, as Premier of the North West, extended an invitation to a number of younger activists from the student movement to spend time in the

province learning how government functioned. I was among those who benefited from that gesture. It was a small but characteristic act — a senior leader of the movement ensuring that the generation coming behind him was not left to discover the mechanics of governance by accident.

That spirit of intergenerational transfer was precisely the ethic KK embodied on campus. He would have approved, quietly and without ceremony, of the idea that those who had been schooled in resistance now had a duty to school others in governance.

SANSCO, Non-Racialism, and the Burden of Transition

The South African National Students' Congress was not simply another campus organisation. It was part of a wider mass democratic tradition, rooted in the conviction that education was inseparable from liberation, and that universities were sites of struggle rather than sanctuaries from politics.

KK belonged to that political world with conviction.

He is recalled as a political commissar of uncommon clarity during the momentous discussions around the unity between SANSCO and NUSAS that culminated in the formation of the South African Students Congress (SASCO) at Rhodes University in September 1991. That was not a minor procedural episode. It was one of the most significant acts of political reconfiguration in student politics during the democratic transition: the attempt to forge a single non-racial progressive student formation in a country still scarred by apartheid's divisions.

Some 600 black and white students from 129 tertiary education institutions converged on Rhodes University for a week of intense deliberation from 1 to 6 September 1991, gathered under the banner: "Towards a Single Non-Racial Student Organisation." The debates were heated, the stakes immense, and the outcome uncertain. The merger of SANSCO and NUSAS was controversial, with many ANC leaders and student activists actively opposing it. Yet it was carried forward by those who believed that a non-racial student movement was not merely desirable but historically necessary.

Among those who played a significant role in the formation of SASCO were Robinson Ramaite, who became the first President, and Kgomotso Masebelanga, elected as its first Secretary-General at the founding conference. Others included Steven Silver, Mike Koyana, David Makhura, Mfundo Nkuhlu, Naledzani Mashapa, and many more. KK's role as political commissar during those discussions — summarising debates, clarifying positions, ensuring that ideological coherence was not sacrificed to tactical expediency — was remembered by those present as indispensable.

As one account of that inaugural conference records: "I remember vividly how the late Mike Koyana of UWC and Steve Silver of Wits, both Presidents of SANSCO and NUSAS respectively, captured the political significance of the merger. I fully remember how the late KK Papiyane, our Political Commissar, succinctly summarised the heated debates around the merger."

Such moments demanded more than sentiment. They required political education, strategic patience, and the ability to hold together competing historical inheritances without surrendering principle. They required leaders who could explain to their peers why unity mattered, what its terms ought to be, and how one could pursue non-racialism without erasing the material and historical asymmetries produced by white supremacy.

In later years, others would acquire titles, platforms, and public prominence. But it is worth remembering that before there are statesmen, there must be political teachers. Before institutions can be transformed, a generation must first be schooled in the discipline of transformation itself. KK helped perform that work.

The Little Red Golf and the Moving Seminar

I have spoken of the public face of struggle — congresses, rallies, statements, resolutions, marches, clashes with authority. Yet comradeship is also built in the quieter intervals between events. It is in those spaces that one truly learns the measure of another human being.

We travelled together. That simple sentence carries more political meaning than it might appear to bear.

There was a little red Golf Chico. In that small car, KK and I, together with the late Bongani Gxilitshé, Lincoln Mali, and the late Mzwandile Poswa — known to all of us as Tswai Radebe — drove the long roads of the Eastern Cape and beyond to attend student meetings and conferences. We went to Johannesburg for national congresses. We went to Alice, to Mthatha, to campuses across the region where SANSCO and later SASCO branches needed political support, strategic guidance, or simply the visible presence of comrades from Rhodes.

In the boot of that little red car, we carried books and political pamphlets. I mention this not as picturesque detail but because it captures something essential about the character of our political formation. We were not travelling as delegates performing institutional roles. We were travelling as students of the struggle, carrying our political library with us. The texts in that boot — Fanon's *The Wretched of the Earth*, Biko's *I Write What I Like*, the Freedom Charter, ANC and SACP discussion documents, SANSCO policy papers — were not accessories to the journey. They were the journey. Every destination was an extension of the seminar that had begun in Founders Hall and continued on every road we drove.

Those hours in the car were an education. Conversation moved seamlessly from high political theory to the granular details of campus organising: how to manage an SRC election campaign, how to draft a memorandum to a vice-chancellor, how to articulate a demand for curriculum reform in language that the institution could not dismiss as incoherent. KK possessed an infectious, quiet wit. He had a remarkable gift for using humour to diffuse tension during high-stress moments without ever diminishing the gravity of the work at hand. He was never showy in these conversations. His intelligence did not arrive wrapped in self-advertisement. It emerged through the quality of his questions, the calmness of his reasoning, and the seriousness with which he treated even passing political moments.

Bongani Gxilitshé, who would later become the first Provincial Secretary of the ANC in the Eastern Cape and a deeply respected public servant, was part of that travelling circle. His own

political formation had been sharpened in the same student movement. He held a BA from Vista University (1989), an HDE from Rhodes (1991), a Master of Management in Local Governance and Development from Wits (2001), and an MPhil in Economic Policy from Stellenbosch (2012). Bongani carried into those journeys a combination of organisational discipline and intellectual curiosity that made him a natural interlocutor. He understood, as KK did, that the movement required people who could think and organise simultaneously — not one or the other.

Lincoln Mali, then President of the Black Student Movement, Eastern Cape Chairperson of SANSCO, and founding National Vice President of SASCO, brought to those journeys a different but complementary energy. Lincoln was a connector — someone who could move between the campus, the community, and the national structures with fluency. He had been at the centre of the 1991 SASCO launch at Rhodes and understood, perhaps better than anyone in our circle, the mechanics of building organisational coalitions across institutional and racial boundaries. His presence in the car was not merely logistical. It was political. He represented the bridge between local organising and national strategy.

Tswai — Mzwandile Poswa — was our quiet anchor. He had come to Rhodes from Fort Hare, carrying what he described as “a bag full of revolutionary dreams.” He was at the epicentre of the 1991 SASCO launch and served as secretary of the local SASCO branch at Rhodes. Tswai was the kind of comrade who did not seek the microphone but whose organisational reliability made the work of those who did possible. His later life — in business, in publishing, in community development — was a continuation of the same impulse that had driven him as a student: to build, to organise, to serve.

Both Bongani and Tswai are gone now. Their absence is part of the long shadow of loss that falls over any honest recollection of that generation.

That little red Golf Chico carried more than five young men. It carried a political tradition. And the books in its boot were the fuel that kept that tradition alive between destinations.

The Comrades and the Long Shadow of Loss

One does not speak truthfully about that generation without speaking also of absence. Memory, when it is faithful, is never only about achievement. It is also about those whose names must still be spoken because history has not done enough to hold them.

In remembering that generation, Simpiwe “Piya” Dzengwa and I have often found ourselves returning to the names of comrades no longer with us: Mike Koyana, KK Chule Papiyana, Sheya Kulati, Kgomotso Masebelanga, Vusumzi Nonyalela, Thami Rubusana, Mvuzo Mbebe, KK Kula and others. To that litany, I add the names of Bongani Gxilitse, Luthando Myataza “Takes” and Mzwandile “Tswai Radebe” Poswa — comrades whose paths formed part of the wider political life of our generation.

That litany of names should not pass as mere sentiment. It should trouble us. It should force upon us the recognition that the student movement was peopled by lives of enormous promise, not all of whom were granted the time or institutional memory equal to their contribution.

Kgomotso Masebelanga, the first Secretary General of SASCO, was murdered in 2003 at his grandmother's graveside in Dobsonville, Soweto — shot dead during a robbery. He had been a medical doctor, a man who had devoted himself to free HIV treatment at Mofolo Hospice Clinic. Minutes before his death, he had quoted Benjamin Pogrund's book on Robert Sobukwe: "To every man upon this earth, death cometh soon or late."

Mike Koyana, the SANSCO President who, alongside Steve Silver of NUSAS, had captured the political significance of the merger that formed SASCO, is also gone.

These are not footnotes. They are foundational figures. And their absence from our national memory is itself a political failure.

There is a deeper injustice in how such figures are remembered. Public memory often privileges those who later accumulated official distinction. Yet movements are not sustained by office alone. They are sustained by the organisers of consciousness, the guardians of internal discipline, the comrades who carry political clarity into moments of confusion, and the teachers who prevent a generation from mistaking heat for light.

KK performed that role.

The Political Commissar and the Ethics of Formation

It is no small thing to be remembered as a political commissar by those who knew the weight of that task. In serious traditions of struggle, a political commissar is not merely an enforcer of orthodoxy. Properly understood, he is a custodian of political line, moral direction, educational depth and organisational coherence. He is charged with ensuring that action remains tethered to purpose, that impatience does not overwhelm principle, and that the movement does not lose sight of its historical mission.

Everything I know of KK confirms that he inhabited this role with maturity.

He possessed that difficult balance between ideological firmness and human generosity. He could be exacting, but not petty. He could be critical, but not destructive. He knew how to correct without humiliating. He understood that young activists do not become politically durable merely by being flattered; they become durable by being sharpened.

And he knew that politics without ethics eventually devours itself.

The late-night strategy sessions captured this ethic perfectly. Hours after mass meetings had concluded and the crowds had dispersed, a smaller group would gather in modest rooms in Founders Hall or in the residences that adjoined it. With tea brewing and notebooks open, KK would meticulously dissect the day's events. He would ask probing questions: "What was management's real objective in that clause?" or "How do we ensure our general membership understands the strategic reason for this tactical compromise?" or "What is the ideological assumption behind this demand, and does it hold under scrutiny?"

These were not interrogations. They were exercises in political education conducted in real time, with real consequences, under real pressure. They were the unglamorous labour that made the visible victories possible.

In times of personal difficulty or political frustration, KK was the person you turned to. He offered grounded counsel, stripped of posturing or pretence. He measured people not by their public rhetoric, but by their private integrity, their loyalty to the collective, and their consistency when the spotlight was off.

Why KK Matters Now

It may be asked why, in a nation burdened by so many urgent crises, it remains necessary to write at length about a student leader and political educator from the transition era. The answer is that nations decay not only when they lose policy coherence, but when they lose memory of the standards that once formed their best people.

South Africa today continues to wrestle with unfinished questions of inequality, institutional confidence, youth disillusionment and a thinning culture of political seriousness. At such a moment, remembrance must do more than mourn. It must recover usable traditions. KK offers one such tradition.

He belongs to a lineage that understood education as a site of democratic struggle, non-racialism as a principled political horizon rather than a cosmetic slogan, and leadership as disciplined service rather than theatrical entitlement. He stands for a mode of politics in which young people were expected to read, think, organise, negotiate, build alliances, defend principle, and connect campus issues to the wider suffering and aspirations of the people.

That tradition needs recovery.

For those of us who knew him, the obligation is sharper still. We cannot allow a man of his calibre to vanish into the footnotes of other people's biographies. If an SACP district can bear his name — the KK Chule Papiyane 4th District, covering parts of the Sarah Baartman region in the Eastern Cape — then surely the national political memory can bear the weight of his story.

The Politics of Remembering

Let us therefore name him properly and fully: Chule “KK” Papiyana. And let us insist on the same historical care when recording the lives of black political organisers that we demand when remembering more celebrated public figures. Naming is not cosmetic. It is political. To remember accurately is to resist disappearance.

Let us correct error where error has crept in. Let us refuse the sloppiness that often attends the remembrance of black political lives. Let us speak his name with the historical care we would demand for more celebrated figures. For naming is not cosmetic. It is political. To name correctly is to restore dignity. To remember accurately is to resist disappearance.

In remembering KK, we remember also the wider generation whose political education, organising and sacrifice helped make the democratic transition possible.

In remembering KK, one remembers them too.

A Closing Reckoning

I write this not as an antiquarian exercise, nor as an indulgence in nostalgia, but as a political act of retrieval. Chule "KK" Papiyana represented a kind of leadership South Africa urgently needs to remember: intellectually serious, morally grounded, organisationally disciplined, strategically mature, and deeply committed to the democratic advancement of black people within a non-racial and just social order.

He was my friend, my mentor, and my comrade. We travelled together in a little red car, carrying books in the boot and conviction in our chests. He taught me, by example more than instruction, that politics is not a race toward personal visibility. It is an apprenticeship in service.

If today we seek examples of what political adulthood looks like, we need not search only among presidents, ministers, or public intellectuals with global platforms. We can also look back to the residence rooms of Founders Hall, the movement debates that stretched past midnight, the campus marches that drew the surveillance of the state, and the long Eastern Cape roads where men like KK helped prepare a generation for the burdens of history.

His was not the politics of spectacle. It was the politics of substance.

His was not the language of vanity. It was the language of responsibility.

His was not an accidental maturity. It was a disciplined one.

And that is why his life continues to matter.

To remember Chule "KK" Papiyana is to remember that the struggle was carried not only by those who reached the summit of visibility, but also by those who did the quieter work of forming the minds of others. Men like him did not merely participate in history. They tutored it, steadied it, and in crucial moments, gave it direction.

South Africa owes them more than occasional mention. It owes them historical honour.

KK was one of those men.

And history, if it is to remain worthy of the people who made it, must say so plainly.

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COMPLETE PHOTO ARCHIVE

All seven photographs consolidated with the article for archival and circulation purposes.

PHOTO 1



Chule “KK” Papiyana — political educator, organiser and mentor to a generation.

PHOTO 2



Rhodes University, where a generation of black student politics was sharpened and organised.

PHOTO 3



An early-morning game at Steyn City — one of the quieter spaces for reflection, friendship and conversation beyond public life.

PHOTO 4



A student-era photograph from a generation whose friendships, debates and journeys helped shape South Africa's political transition.

PHOTO 5



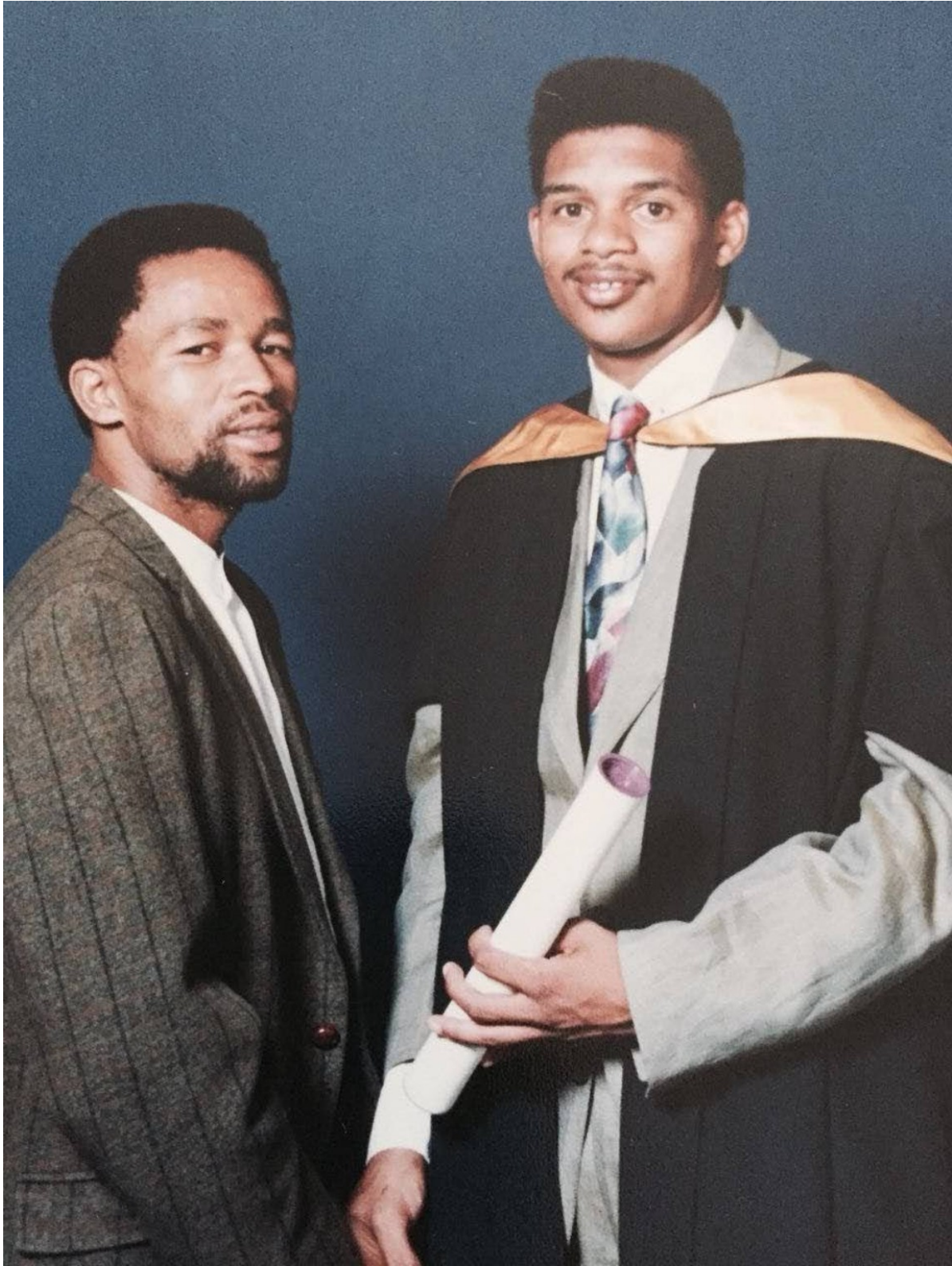
Zola Pinda with Lincoln Mali at Rhodes University during the 1993 graduation ceremony — a moment marking the transition from student activism into the responsibilities that followed.

PHOTO 6



A family journey to Peddie in the Eastern Cape — a personal return to the landscape of formation.

PHOTO 7



The little red Golf Chico and the travelling circle of comrades whose journeys became part of the political education of a generation.